From project-driven work to repeatable operations

Led by Brian Wilhite, Owner: aligning acquisition, hiring, estimating, and administration at an established Tucson service business.

BUSINESS CONTEXT

Prestige was already serving **Realtors, property managers, and selected commercial accounts**. Much of the residential work was one-time deep cleaning or move-out projects. Recurring residential service was a **small existing line**, not a new business launched from zero.

THE OPERATING PROBLEM

One-time projects generated revenue but carried variable labor requirements: overruns could compress margins to nearly zero. A recurring offer required more than new advertisements. It required **repeatable delivery, faster hiring, consistent quotes, and lighter administration**, even when the owner was working in the field.

ACQUISITION & DELIVERY INDICATORS

8	$107	~$295	~41%
META-ATTRIBUTED	**MEDIA-ONLY CAC**	**AGENCY-INCL. CAC**	**JOB CONTRIBUTION**
recurring customers	reported estimate	per acquired client	after direct costs

THE DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Build ahead of the demand curve: prepare core workflows to handle additional recurring customers even when owner time is consumed by field work.

Prepare the system before volume arrives

Instead of waiting for customer growth to expose bottlenecks, the owner front-loaded process design while field work was already consuming operating time.

01 Customer acquisition

Tested Google in July; the resulting demand leaned toward one-time projects. Redirected acquisition toward recurring households through Meta. Used external expertise to accelerate setup while retaining the advertising accounts and creative assets.

Design choice: buy expertise, retain control.

02 Hiring & training

Built a staged funnel: group interviews, one-to-one interviews, and typically three paid working days that doubled as initial training. Emphasized reliability, coachability, and fit for standardized recurring work.

Design choice: evaluate quickly before committing.

03 Software & quoting

Weighed finishing custom Airtable automations and maintaining ClickUp against a more integrated platform. Selected BookingKoala for automated texts/emails and a configurable quoting calculator usable in the field or by a delegate.

Status: functional estimating; refinement ongoing.

04 Administrative leverage

Built small LLM-assisted workflows for invoicing and checklist preparation to reduce repetitive coordination. The objective was to keep routine administrative work manageable while the owner was assigned to on-site service delivery.

Status: practical aids; time savings not measured.

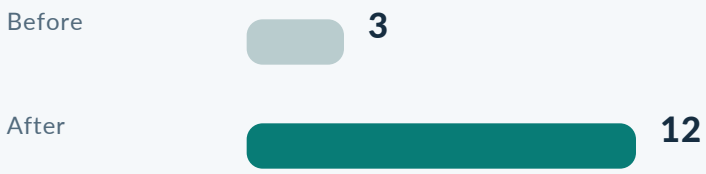
Training context: routine-cleaning onboarding targeted roughly one week, compared with 2–3 months for the more complex deep-cleaning scope. These are different service requirements, not a controlled time-saving experiment.

Early validation, measured with discipline

The acquisition initiative expanded a small recurring-service line and tested whether its delivery economics could support a more repeatable operating model.

RECURRING SERVICE-LINE GROWTH

RESIDENTIAL CLIENTS



RECURRING REVENUE

+188%

Growth in the monthly recurring-service revenue baseline; not overall company revenue.

The 3-to-12 client increase represents **early-stage service-line growth from a small base**. Neither percentage establishes a mature or sustained growth rate.

CUSTOMER ACQUISITION ACCOUNTING

MEDIA-ONLY CAC

$107

AGENCY-INCLUSIVE CAC

~$295

Eight of nine net new recurring clients came through Meta. Agency-inclusive CAC spreads two months of management fees across eight acquisitions; internal time and overhead are excluded.

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUPPORTS

The owner coordinated recurring acquisition, staged hiring, service software, field estimating, and administrative support as one operating model. Reported recurring-job contribution was **~41%** after direct labor (including paid owner labor) and materials.

Evidence limits: the initial customer cohort is small; long-term retention, quoting accuracy, administrative time savings, and owner-independent delivery are not yet measured. The 41% excludes acquisition costs and overhead.